# Health Building Lifestyle Guidelines

2026 Comprehensive Edition

A practical, illustrated guide to everyday habits for long-term health.

**Based on globally recognised lifestyle medicine science that helps in preventing and treating diseases** [1,6,9–19].

## How to use this guide

**1. Check your lifestyle score** (out of 21, negative counting for ●1–7).

- Red = avoid
- Green = eat
- Yellow = do

The score is for self-reflection, **not** diagnosis or a clinical risk score.

**2. Pick one or two changes you can keep**.

**3. Spice infusion in morning** (200 ml) (p5).

**4. Daily Yoga protocol** (20 asanas-pranayama) — ●1 (p6).

Continue prescribed medicines till full assessment is done.

**Zenodo:** doi:10.5281/zenodo.24090390

**Free tools:** **lifequality.org.in/assessment** | `21-item-assessment.csv`

The guideline was synthesised from WHO and ICMR-NIN guidance and behaviour-change principles [1,10,17,18].

# Health Building Lifestyle Guidelines

## Foods to be totally avoided [1]

Food containing high amount of salt, refined sugar , refined cereal and fat.

1. Deep fried→fries , pakoras, samosa, kachori, etc.[2][{3}
2. Processed/ Packaged food → chips, patties, breads, biscuits , sauces[4]
3. Confectionery → sweets, chocolates, toffees, cakes, pastries , ice-cream.[5]
4. Carbonated drinks → soft drinks, sodas .[5]
5. Caffeinated drinks→ tea and coffee with milk. [6]
6. Meat →red meat
7. Alcohol.

## Healthy Balanced Diet [1]

Eat from the seven food groups (prefer eating locally produced foods) :

1. Vegetables → Seasonal and green leafy vegetables , salads like beetroot, cucumber , radish. Chutney(coriander, mint, chilies, garlic, ginger, Indian gooseberry.) [7]
2. Fruits → Seasonal fruits
3. Cereals→ Whole wheat, parboiled rice and millets like bajra, jowar, ragi. Fermented cereals , cereal-pulses mix. . [8]
4. Pulses → Whole Pulses, Beans, Sprouted Lentil and Gram.
5. Dairy → Toned Milk , Curd , Buttermilk
6. Oils & Fats → Cook in little oil , steam or boil the food. Add ghee on top of food [9]
7. Sugars→ Jaggery, Honey, Dates, Raisins . (In moderation)[10]

## Adopt a healthy lifestyle [1]

1. Walk/ Exercise /Yoga/ Pranayama for at least 30 minutes a day.
2. Daily Sun exposure. [11]
3. Maintain a healthy body weight (BMI below 25). Lower abdominal fat. [12]
4. Drink adequate water to stay hydrated.
5. Live a stress-free life . Have regular and proper sleep.
6. Abstain from any type of addiction (Tobacco, Alcohol , Drugs, Screen).
7. Meal times should be fixed. Avoid overeating.




## Sample Menu

- Breakfast: Dalia or sprouts salad or idli/ uttappam/ dosa sambar or upma.
- Mid Morning: One fruit (of the season).
- Afternoon : Chapati/Rice/ Khichdi + dal + sabji + buttermilk + salad+ chutney.
- Evening : Soup + same as lunch but in less quantity.

Prefer having last meal of the day before sunset.

**The 2025 guideline, page 1 (English).** Reproduced from *Health Building Lifestyle Guidelines*, Sarwal R, Negi D, Zenodo, 5 July 2025, doi:10.5281/zenodo.15814357, CC BY 4.0. Red = avoid, green = eat, yellow = do.

# स्वास्थ्य निर्माण जीवनशैली के निर्देश

## स्वस्थ जीवन के लिए निषेध भोजन [1]

**नमक, रिफाइंड चीनी, रिफाइंड अनाज और वसा की उच्चमात्रा वाले भोजन :**

1. तला हुआ (डीप फ्राइड)→ फ्राइज़, पकोड़े, समोसा, कचौरी, आदि। [2][3]
2. पैक्ड (रेडीमेड) फूड → चिप्स, पैटीज, ब्रेड, बिस्कुट , रस्क , सॉस आदि । [4]
3. कन्फेक्शनरी → मिठाई, चॉकलेट, टॉफी, केक, पेस्ट्री, आइसक्रीम। [5]
4. कार्बोनेटेड पेय→सॉफ्ट ड्रिंक्स , सोडा ।[5]
5. कैफीनयुक्त पेय →दूध वाली चाय , कॉफ़ी ।[6]
6. मांस→लाल मांस ।
7. शराब

## स्वस्थ संतुलित आहार [1]

**सात खाद्य समूहों से खाएं** (स्थानीय रूप से उत्पादित खाद्य पदार्थों खाने को प्राथमिकता दें) **:**

1. सब्जियां→ताजी और हरी पत्तेदार सब्जियां ।सलाद जैसे चुकंदर ,खीरा , मूली । चटनी ( धनिया,पुदीना, हरी मिर्च, लहसुन, आंवला, अदरक)।[7]
2. फल→मौसम के ताजे फल ।
3. अनाज→साबुत अनाज और मोटा अनाज जैसे बाजरा, जोवर , रागी । खमीर उठा अनाज और अनाज- दाल का मिश्रण ।[8]
4. दाल →साबुत दालें, बीन्स, ग्राम, अंकुरित दाल ।
5. डेयरी → टोंड दूध(कम चिकनाई वाला दूध ), दही , छाछ ।
6. तेल/ घी→ थोड़े तेल में पकाएं। ज्यादातर खाना भाप से या उबला बनाया । ऊपर से कुछ मात्रा में घी डाले ।[9]
7. मीठा→गुड़, शहद, खजूर, किशमिश।(संयम में) [10]

## स्वस्थ जीवन शैली अपनाएं[1]

1. सप्ताह में 5 दिन कम से कम 30 मिनट की सैर/ व्यायाम/ योग और प्राणायाम करें ।
2. रोजाना 20 से 30 मिनट की धूप लें ।[11]
3. शरीर का सही वजन बनाए रखें ( बी. एम. आई. 25 से कम रखें )। पेट पर चर्बी न बढ़ने दें ।[12]
4. पर्याप्त पानी पिएं।
5. तनाव मुक्त जीवन जिएं ।नियमित और उचित नींद लें।
6. किसी भी प्रकार की लत (तंबाकू, शराब , नशा या स्क्रीन) से दूर रहें ।
7. भोजन का समय निश्चित होना चाहिए ।भोजन की मात्रा पर नियंत्रण रखें और अधिक खाने से बचें ।




### मेनू ( उदाहरण )

- नाश्ता: दलिया या अंकुरित दाल का सलाद या इडली या उत्तपम या डोसा + सांबर या उपमा ।
- सुबह: एक फल (मौसम का ) ।
- दोपहर: चपाती, चावल या खिचड़ी + दाल+ सब्ज़ी + छाछ + सलाद+ चटनी ।
- शाम : सूप + दोपहर के अनुरूप पर कम मात्रा में।

दिन का अंतिम भोजन सूर्यास्त से पहले करें।

**The 2025 guideline, page 2 (Hindi / स्वास्थ्य निर्माण जीवनशैली के निर्देश).** Same source and licence: doi:10.5281/zenodo.15814357. Bilingual wording is also in 21-item-assessment.csv and the free online form.

# References


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**The 2025 guideline, page 3 — its own reference list [1]–[12].** Reproduced unchanged from doi:10.5281/zenodo.15814357. The 2026 Edition's own numbered references are on the last page.

# The four-spice morning infusion

**What:** An infusion of 4 spices soaked overnight, taken first thing in the morning.

**Preparation:** **10 g each** of coriander, fenugreek, cumin seeds and cinnamon bark (**40 g total**), soaked overnight in **1 litre of water**; **do not boil**. Take **one 200 ml glass**, lukewarm, before Yoga. Replenish the water for up to **three days**, then prepare a fresh infusion.

**Traditionally recognised benefits:** digestive and warming kitchen spices (cumin, coriander, fenugreek, cinnamon) — traditional culinary use.

## Why?

**Component-level evidence only** — each spice has been studied on its own: cinnamon and fenugreek for blood-sugar control [22,23], cumin in type 2 diabetes [24], coriander for inflammatory markers [25]; a cooked seven-spice curry sharing cumin, coriander and cinnamon (no fenugreek) in a gut-microflora study in healthy adults [26]; **Irritable Bowel Syndrome** (IBS) pilots for symptom control, pain and bloating [27,28]; and an IBS rat model of bowel dysfunction [29].

**Video guide:** ***Wonder of Spices — In one glass every morning*** (Sutra Health).

**Status:** no efficacy claim; not a standard of care; does not replace medicines.




Four spices soaking overnight — Sutra Health.

# Yoga protocol

**The 20-item protocol** elaborates ●1 (Yellow 1) of the 21-item guideline: a warm-up, a sequence of asanas, and pranayama at the end, with a linked video archive for home practice.

- Practice gradually, seek guidance if you get pain or difficulty.
- Remain mindful of movement and breath every time.

**Evidence:** lowers blood pressure [13,16], better glycaemic control [14,15]. Yoga in combination, type 2 diabetes remission [30], coronary heart disease reversal [31].




Group Yoga practice (Surya Namaskar)

Sutra Health | Video archive.

**19 asanas + pranayama**

1. Tadasana
2. Trikonasana
3. Suryanamaskara
5. Savasana
6. Sirshasana
7. Sarvangasana
8. Matsyasana
9. Halasana
10. Paschimottanasana
11. Bhujangasana
12. Makarasana
13. Salabhasana
14. Dhanurasana
15. Chakrasana
16. Ardha-Matsyendrasana
17. Yoga Mudra
18. Mayurasana
19. **Sitting Postures**
    - (1) Padmasana
    - (2) Siddhasana
    - (3) Svastikasana
    - (4) Vajrasana

**20. Pranayama**

- (1) Deep Breathing
- (2) Kapalabhati
- (3) Bhastrika
- (4) Sitali
- (5) Sitkari
- (6) Ujjayi
- (7) Sukha Purvaka

Source: *A practical guide to yoga*, Swami Chidananda — yogaisfree.org.

**Reference site:** **lifequality.org.in/services/therapeutic-yoga/yoga-asana-protocol** [20].

# Six pillars of lifestyle medicine

## 1 Nutrition

**Whole-food, plant-predominant eating** — fibre-filled, nutrient-dense, minimally processed plant foods [6].

*Vegetables, fruits, whole grains, pulses; limit processed food, sugar and unhealthy fats.* ●*1–7* ●*1–7* ●*3, 4, 7* [1,10,11].

## 2 Physical activity

**Regular and consistent physical activity** [6].

*Walk, exercise or Yoga for at least 30 minutes daily.* ●*1, 2; elaborated on p6* [9,13–15].

## 3 Restorative sleep

**Restorative sleep** — adequate, good-quality sleep with a regular night-time routine [6].

*Proper sleep, 7 to 9 hours for most adults.* ●*5* [6,7].

## 4 Stress management

**Incorporating stress-reducing behaviours** for whole-person health [6].

*Stress-free living, pranayama and breathing practices.* ●*5; the Yoga page* [6,13].

## 5 Connectedness

**Strengthening and maintaining relationships** that foster meaning, well-being and long-term outcomes [6].

*Whole-family care, group practice, shared goals. The 2025 protocol encourages family attendance* [1,6].

## 6 Risky substances

**Avoiding behaviours** that include the consumption of or exposure to harmful substances [6].

*Avoid tobacco, alcohol and harmful drugs.* ●*5, 7;* ●*6* [6,19].

**Roman text** under each pillar follows the published six-pillar language of the American College of Lifestyle Medicine [6]; **italics** give the 2025 21-item guideline reproduced on pp 2–4. Discs cross-reference its three groups: ● Red = avoid (1–7), ● Green = eat (1–7), ● Yellow = do (1–7). The bright colours above follow the ACLM six-pillar palette; no ACLM logo is reproduced, and no endorsement is implied.

# Prevention, treatment & remission

## Conditions with evidence, and the practices that work.

**PREVENTION** **TREATMENT** **REMISSION / REVERSAL**

| Condition | Evidence | Practices that work | Ref |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Type 2 diabetes** | **PREVENTION**: lifestyle change prevented / delayed onset in high-risk Asian Indians | Structured diet + physical activity (IDPP-1) | [12] |
| **Type 2 diabetes** | **REMISSION**: 46% reached HbA1c <6.5% off drugs at 12 months | Intensive weight management / total diet replacement (DiRECT) | [30] |
| **Coronary heart disease** | **REVERSAL**: regression of coronary atherosclerosis over 5 years | Intensive lifestyle change: vegetarian diet, exercise, stress management, group support (Lifestyle Heart Trial) | [31] |
| **CVD, cancer, mortality** | **PREVENTION**: plant-forward patterns associated with lower risk | Whole-food plant-forward eating (ICMR-NIN dietary guidelines) | [10,11] |
| **Hypertension** | **TREATMENT**: lower office BP; Yoga lowers BP | Yoga; lifestyle intervention versus usual care | [13,16] |
| **Glycaemic control (T2DM)** | **TREATMENT**: improved glycaemic control | Yoga asana / pranayama | [14] |
| **Chronic disease burden** | **PREVENTION**: leading risks are high BP, smoking, high glucose, high BMI | Six pillars; WHO 150–300 min moderate activity weekly | [9,19] |

**Selected meta-analyses (prevention):** Kyu HH, et al. *BMJ* 2016;354:i3857 — dose–response meta-analysis of 174 cohorts: higher total physical activity associated with 14–28% lower risk of diabetes, ischaemic heart disease, stroke, breast and colon cancer [32]; Reynolds A, et al. *Lancet* 2019;393(10170):434–45 — a series of systematic reviews and meta-analyses: higher dietary fibre and whole-grain intake associated with lower incidence of non-communicable disease and mortality [33].

# References

**2026 Edition** references; the reproduced 2025 handout has its own list [1]–[12] on p 4.


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